FILM MAKING AND RADIO PODCASTING CD23731

REPORT

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BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

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CHAPTER 1 INTRODUCTION

Film making is a creative form of visual communication that combines storytelling, acting, cinematography, sound, lighting and editing to communicate an idea or experience to an audience. A short film presents a complete story within a limited duration, making it important to develop a clear concept and use every scene effectively. Radio podcasting, on the other hand, communicates stories through audio elements such as narration, dialogue, music, sound effects and silence. Both forms require creativity, planning and effective storytelling.

The project titled "THE WARNING" is a short thriller film developed as part of the Film Making and Radio Podcasting course. The story begins with a college student, Arun, walking through an empty corridor while speaking to his friend Vicky on the phone about meeting him near the gate. While he is still walking, he receives an unexpected call from an unknown number. The caller warns him that he has only two minutes and tells him not to trust anyone.

Moments later, Vicky appears at the end of the corridor. Arun receives a message that reads, "HE IS NOT VICKY." This single line changes the tone of the entire film, turning an ordinary meeting between two friends into a situation filled with doubt and suspicion. As Arun tries to confirm whether the person beside him is really his friend, a series of strange events - an unanswered phone, a second phone ringing alone on a classroom bench, and a call from what appears to be the real Vicky - pull him deeper into confusion.

The project is designed not only as a visual short film built around a continuous opening shot, but also as a story that can be adapted into a radio podcast. The visual uncertainty created by the corridor, the classroom and the reveal at the door can be replaced in the podcast version by narration, voice acting, sound effects and silence.

CHAPTER 2 PROJECT OVERVIEW

The main idea of THE WARNING is to take an everyday moment - walking through college to meet a friend - and gradually turn it into a situation where the audience can no longer be sure who to trust. The opening two minutes are shot as a single continuous take, which makes the world feel real and unbroken. This sense of reliability is deliberately built up so that it can be disrupted the moment the unknown call arrives.

After the unknown caller's warning, the atmosphere begins to shift. The message "HE IS NOT VICKY" introduces the central doubt of the film. The failed phone test, where Arun calls Vicky's number and it does not ring in Vicky's hand, adds a logical layer of suspicion. The classroom scene, where a second phone lies ringing on the last bench, escalates the mystery further, and the door opening in the final scene brings the tension to its peak.

The film uses two connected locations - a college corridor and an empty classroom - a small number of characters, and ordinary props such as mobile phones. This keeps the project practical to produce while still allowing techniques such as the continuous long take, identity-based suspense and an unresolved loop ending to be demonstrated.

CHAPTER 3 TITLE – THE WARNING

The title "THE WARNING" refers directly to the phone call Arun receives at the very beginning of the story, in which an unknown voice tells him he has only two minutes and warns him not to trust anyone. On the surface, this appears to be a warning meant to protect him.

As the story unfolds, the meaning of the title becomes less certain. The same unknown caller who issues the warning is also the one who later says, "Sorry Arun... unakku warning kudukka try panninen," suggesting regret rather than malice. Yet the warning never fully explains what Arun is being protected from, and the loop ending suggests that the warning may not have been enough, or may always arrive too late. The title therefore works on two levels: it is the literal warning call that opens the film, and it is a broader comment on how a warning is only useful if it is understood in time.

CHAPTER 4 GENRE

The film belongs to the psychological thriller and mystery genre. Rather than relying on visible danger or jump scares, the suspense is built through doubt about identity and through withheld information. The audience is never shown who the unknown caller is or given a clear answer about whether Vicky can be trusted.

The mystery is sustained by giving the audience information at the same pace as Arun. Every discovery he makes - the failed phone test, the second phone on the last bench, the real Vicky's voice on the call, the figure at the door - is discovered by the audience at the same moment, which keeps the tension personal and immediate.

The major suspense elements used in the film are:

- An unknown phone call
- A warning message: "HE IS NOT VICKY"
- Doubt over a friend's real identity
- A phone that does not ring when it should
- A second phone ringing alone on an empty bench
- A message that says, "NOW LOOK BEHIND YOU"
- An apology from the unknown caller
- A repeating, looping timeline
- A shadow that appears only the second time
- The mysterious final video file

CHAPTER 5 OBJECTIVES

The main objective of the project is to create an engaging short psychological thriller using a continuous long-take opening and a simple two-location production setup. The project also aims to demonstrate how camera movement, timing, dialogue and sound can be combined to create suspense without relying on visual effects.

The specific objectives are:

- To develop an original short-film story built around identity-based suspense.
- To plan and execute a continuous long-take (one-shot) opening sequence.
- To understand screenplay and real-time scene development.
- To practice natural, conversational dialogue writing in Tamil and English.
- To create suspense primarily through timing, dialogue and sound rather than visual reveals.
- To develop basic video editing skills, including disguising cuts within a long take.
- To understand the importance of background sound and silence in building tension.
- To adapt the story into a radio podcast format.

To understand the difference between visual and audio storytelling

CHAPTER 6 STORY DEVELOPMENT

The story was developed around a simple but unsettling idea: what if the person walking beside you, someone you have known for years, might not actually be who they claim to be, and the very warning meant to protect you cannot be fully trusted either. The concept was deliberately kept to two locations and three voices so that the suspense could be built through writing and performance rather than large-scale production.

The first two minutes establish Arun's ordinary routine and his easy friendship with Vicky through natural, casual conversation, filmed as a single continuous shot so the audience trusts what they are seeing. The unknown call interrupts this normalcy and plants the first seed of doubt. Vicky's appearance immediately afterward, followed by the warning message, forces both Arun and the audience to reconsider a character who has not changed at all in appearance or behaviour.

The middle section was developed to test that doubt logically - the failed call to Vicky's phone gives Arun, and the audience, a concrete reason to be suspicious rather than a vague feeling. The classroom sequence escalates the mystery through the second phone and the real Vicky's voice, deepening the confusion about who is actually present in the room. The final section was built to peak at the door reveal and then fold back on itself through the loop ending, leaving the story intentionally unresolved.

CHAPTER 7 STORY SYNOPSIS

The film opens on Arun walking alone through an empty college corridor, talking to his friend Vicky on the phone about meeting near the gate. Their conversation is light and familiar, filled with friendly complaints about being kept waiting. As Arun continues walking, his phone suddenly rings again - this time from an unknown number.

He answers, confused. The unknown caller asks if he is alone and tells him that he has only two minutes before something happens, warning him not to trust anyone. The call disconnects abruptly. Almost immediately, Vicky appears at the end of the corridor and calls out to him. Arun turns, visibly shaken but says nothing is wrong. As Vicky walks closer, Arun's phone vibrates with a new message: "HE IS NOT VICKY."

Arun slowly looks at Vicky, unsure of what to believe. Vicky asks about the message and demands to see the phone, but Arun refuses. To test his suspicion, Arun calls Vicky's number directly - and Vicky's phone does not ring. When asked where his phone is, Vicky only smiles and says it is in his room. Arun takes a step back.

Frightened, Arun runs into an empty classroom and locks the door behind him. He calls the unknown number again, demanding answers. The caller tells him he is safe and insists that Vicky is not really his friend. Following the caller's instructions, Arun turns toward the last bench in the classroom and finds a phone lying there. It begins to ring, displaying "VICKY CALLING..." on the screen.

Arun answers, and hears Vicky's real voice - sounding completely normal, asking where he is and saying he has been waiting at the gate the whole time. Arun stares at the phone in his hand, unable to reconcile what he is hearing with what he has just seen.

The classroom door slowly opens. Vicky is standing outside. Arun steps backward and tells him not to come closer. Another message arrives: "NOW LOOK BEHIND YOU." Arun turns around slowly - there is nobody there. When he looks back, Vicky insists that he really is Arun's friend. The unknown number calls one final time. The caller apologizes, saying he only tried to warn Arun. When Arun asks what he is supposed to have seen, the caller simply says, "Un pinnadi" - behind you. The screen cuts to black, followed by a loud notification sound. On-screen text reads

CHAPTER 8 CHARACTERS

Arun is the main character of the film. He begins the story relaxed and playful in his conversation with Vicky, and his emotional state shifts gradually from mild irritation, to confusion, to genuine fear as the events of the film unfold. Because so much of the film's information is delivered through phone calls and text messages, Arun's facial reactions and body language carry much of the emotional weight of the story.

Vicky is Arun's close friend and the character at the centre of the film's central doubt. He is never shown to behave any differently from how a normal friend would, which is precisely what makes the message "HE IS NOT VICKY" so unsettling - the audience has no visual reason to distrust him, only the warning itself.

The Unknown Caller is never seen and exists only as a voice on the phone and as text messages on Arun's screen. This character issues both the warning and the final apology, and is the film's most ambiguous presence - neither clearly a villain nor clearly a protector. Keeping this character unseen and unexplained is central to maintaining the film's mystery.

CHAPTER 9 SCENE DEVELOPMENT

9.1 Scene 1 – College Corridor

The film opens with the camera positioned behind Arun as he walks through an empty corridor, talking to Vicky on the phone. This entire scene, up to the point where Vicky's message appears, is designed as one continuous, unbroken shot lasting close to two minutes. The uninterrupted camera movement is intended to make the world of the film feel real and trustworthy before that trust is broken.

The conversation with Vicky is casual and familiar. The unknown call then interrupts the mood - the caller's warning and sudden disconnection should be played with minimal camera movement so the audience focuses entirely on Arun's reaction. Vicky's appearance at the end of the corridor and the arrival of the message, "HE IS NOT VICKY," close the scene on a note of quiet unease rather than an obvious scare.

9.2 Scene 2 – Corridor (The Phone Test)

Vicky asks about the message and requests to see Arun's phone. Arun's refusal and hesitation should be played naturally, as though he is embarrassed by his own suspicion. When he calls Vicky's number and it fails to ring in Vicky's hand, the moment should be held for a few extra seconds without dialogue, allowing the silence itself to communicate the shock.

Vicky's calm smile as he says his phone is "in his room" is one of the most important beats of the film - his lack of concern should feel more unsettling than a visibly aggressive reaction would.

9.3 Scene 3 – Empty Room

Arun enters the room, and the sound of the door locking behind him should be emphasized to mark this space as a place of temporary safety. His call to the unknown number can be shot in close-up on his face and phone screen. When he turns toward the last bench and discovers the second phone, the camera should slowly push in on the ringing screen before he answers it.

Hearing Vicky's real, unworried voice on this second phone - while the person claiming to be Vicky is presumably still outside - should be shot with Arun's expression changing gradually rather than all at once, showing his growing disbelief.

9.4 Scene 4 – The Reveal

The room door opening slowly, with Vicky standing outside, should be shot from Arun's point of view to place the audience directly in his position of fear. The message "NOW LOOK BEHIND YOU" and Arun's hesitant turn toward an empty space builds suspense through anticipation rather than a visible threat.

The final phone call, in which the unknown caller apologizes and says only "un pinnadi," should be delivered quietly, almost gently, contrasting with the urgency of the earlier warning. The cut to black, the loud notification sound, and the on-screen text "2 MINUTES EARLIER..." should feel abrupt, before the opening corridor shot restarts identically - except for the shadow now visible behind Arun.

CHAPTER 10 CLIMAX AND ENDING

The climax of the film occurs at the classroom door, when Vicky is revealed standing outside just after Arun has heard the real Vicky's voice on a separate phone. This is deepened by the message "NOW LOOK BEHIND YOU" and the unknown caller's final, quiet line, "un pinnadi" - "behind you."

The film does not clarify who or what was truly behind Arun, whether Vicky is genuinely his friend, or who the unknown caller really is. Instead of resolving these questions, the story loops back to its opening corridor shot, now with a shadow visible behind Arun that was not there before. This structure suggests that the events may repeat endlessly, or that Arun has always been followed by something he never noticed the first time.

The ending is intentionally open-ended and unresolved. This ambiguity is central to the thriller experience, allowing the audience to form their own interpretation of who the unknown caller is and what the loop represents.

CHAPTER 11 CINEMATOGRAPHY

The film's most distinctive cinematographic choice is its continuous, unbroken opening shot lasting close to two minutes, following Arun from behind as he walks and talks. This long-take approach requires careful blocking, rehearsed dialogue timing and a stabilized or well-operated handheld camera, since any visible error breaks the illusion of a single, uninterrupted moment.

As the story moves into the corridor test and the classroom, the camera language shifts to closer, more controlled shots - close-ups of phone screens, over-the-shoulder framing during the calls, and a slow push-in on the second phone as it rings. The classroom door opening in the final scene is best shot from Arun's point of view, placing the audience directly in his position.

At the very end, the film deliberately returns to the same continuous-shot style used at the opening, so that the repetition is visually recognizable to the audience even before the on-screen text confirms it, with the addition of the shadow being the only visible difference.

CHAPTER 12 LIGHTING

The opening corridor scene uses natural, everyday college lighting to establish a realistic and familiar atmosphere, in keeping with the continuous-shot approach. As the unknown call interrupts the scene, lighting should remain largely unchanged at first, so that the disruption is carried by performance and sound rather than a visible shift in mood.

The empty classroom is lit more sparsely, using a single practical source such as window light or one tube light, leaving parts of the room in shadow. This isolates Arun within the frame and makes the last bench, where the second phone is found, feel like a distinct pocket of light within a darker space.

In the final scenes, particularly around the door reveal and the loop ending, the lighting can be dimmed slightly further, and care should be taken in the closing shot to allow the shadow behind Arun to be just visible without being obvious on first viewing.

CHAPTER 13 SOUND DESIGN

Sound plays a central role in THE WARNING, since much of the story is delivered through phone calls, messages and the ambient sound of two locations rather than through visible action.

The opening corridor scene relies on footsteps, distant college ambience and the natural sound of the phone conversation to establish realism. As the unknown call arrives, a distinct, unfamiliar ringtone should separate it clearly from Vicky's calls. The message notification sound should also be distinct and slightly jarring each time it appears.

The classroom scene benefits from a more hollow, reverberant sound design to convey emptiness, with the ringing of the second phone standing out sharply against silence. Sudden removal of ambient sound before key reveals - such as the door opening or the final phone call - can make the following moment far more effective.

Important sound elements include:

- Footsteps in the corridor
- Background college ambience
- Distinct ringtone for the unknown caller
- Distinct ringtone for Vicky
- Message notification sound
- Door lock and door creak
- Empty-room reverb in the classroom
- Low-frequency ambience under the unknown caller's voice
- Sudden silence before major reveals
- Loud notification sound at the loop transition

CHAPTER 14 EDITING TECHNIQUES

The opening scene is edited to appear as a single continuous take, which may involve either an actual unbroken shot or carefully disguised cuts hidden behind movement, doorways or camera whip-pans, so that no visible cut breaks the flow of the first two minutes.

As the film moves into the corridor test and room scenes, editing shifts to a more conventional rhythm of close-ups and reaction shots, allowing the pace to quicken as suspense builds. Screen text for phone messages should be timed precisely against the notification sound so that the audience reads each message at the same moment Arun does.

The loop ending is edited to closely mirror the framing and pacing of the opening shot, so that the audience recognizes the repetition instantly, with only the added shadow marking the difference. This technique of near-identical repetition with one small change is central to the film's unresolved, cyclical structure.

CHAPTER 15 USE OF PROPS AND LOCATION

The project is designed to be produced using two simple, easily accessible locations and a minimal set of props. The main locations are a college corridor and one empty classroom.

The major props required are:

- Two mobile phones (Arun's phone and the second phone found on the last bench)
- A room desk and bench
- A room door with a working lock
- A backpack or bag for Arun
- Basic room furniture for background detail

Because the story unfolds almost entirely through two connected locations and two phones, the production remains practical while still allowing the continuous-shot technique and identity-based suspense to be fully demonstrated.

CHAPTER 16 RADIO PODCAST ADAPTATION

The same story can be adapted into a radio podcast by removing its visual dependency and replacing visual information with sound design, voice performance and, where necessary, brief narration.

In the short film, the audience sees the continuous shot of Arun walking through the corridor. In the podcast, this must be conveyed through footsteps, ambient college sounds and the natural rhythm of the phone conversation with Vicky, without needing a narrator to describe the setting in detail.

The failed phone test, the second phone ringing on the last bench, and the room door opening all depend heavily on visual confirmation in the film. In the podcast, these moments must instead be built through sound alone - a phone that stays silent when it should ring, a second ringtone appearing from an unexpected direction in the stereo field, and the creak of a door combined with Vicky's voice approaching. The final "look behind you" moment, which relies entirely on a visual absence in the film, can be recreated in audio through a brief, deliberate silence where footsteps or breathing might be expected.

CHAPTER 17 RADIO PODCAST SCRIPT APPROACH

The podcast version can open directly with footsteps and corridor ambience under the phone conversation between Arun and Vicky, avoiding narration so the scene feels as immediate as the film's continuous shot. The unknown caller's ringtone should be introduced as a clearly different sound from Vicky's, cueing the listener before any dialogue confirms who is calling.

During the corridor test, the absence of a ringing sound from Vicky's pocket is the key audio cue and should be given a moment of silence to register with the listener. The classroom scene can use reverb and reduced ambience to suggest an empty room, with the second phone's ringtone entering sharply against that quiet.

For the door reveal, a creaking door sound combined with Vicky's voice from a distance can replace the visual of him standing there. The "look behind you" moment can be built through a pause with no footsteps or breathing detected, letting silence carry the tension. The unknown caller's final apology and the line "un pinnadi" should be delivered softly, followed immediately by a sharp cut to silence, the notification sound, and a spoken or text-to-audio cue for "two minutes earlier" before the opening ambience restarts - this time with a very faint, added footstep sound trailing behind Arun's own

CHAPTER 18 VOICE AND AUDIO PERFORMANCE

Voice acting carries the full weight of the podcast version, since the audience has no visual cues to rely on. Arun's voice should begin relaxed and conversational, gradually shifting into hesitation, confusion and fear as the story progresses, without becoming overly dramatic too early.

Vicky's voice must remain entirely consistent and unremarkable throughout, since the doubt around his identity should come from the story and sound design, not from any change in how he is performed. The unknown caller's voice benefits from a distinct, slightly distorted or lowered treatment to separate it clearly from the other two characters, while still sounding human rather than exaggerated.

The following elements are important:

- Clear, natural pronunciation of english dialogue
- Appropriate pauses before and after key messages
- Gradual, not sudden, emotional escalation in Arun's voice
- Consistent voice performance for Vicky throughout
- Distinct voice treatment for the unknown caller
- Controlled speaking speed during tense moments
- Effective and deliberate use of silence

CHAPTER 19 PRODUCTION PROCESS

The production of the project can be divided into three stages: pre-production, production and post-production.

During pre-production, the screenplay was finalized, including the natural English dialogue between Arun and Vicky. The continuous-shot opening was carefully shot-listed and blocked in advance, since it requires precise timing between the actors, the camera operator and the phone-call cues. The corridor and classroom locations were scouted, and the two phones used as props were prepared with the required screens, messages and ringtones.

During production, the continuous opening shot was rehearsed multiple times before recording to ensure the dialogue, walking pace and phone interruptions aligned correctly. Coverage shots for the corridor test, the classroom scene and the door reveal were then recorded separately, along with close-up inserts of phone screens and messages. Voice recordings for the podcast adaptation were prepared alongside the film production.

During post-production, the continuous shot was edited to remove any visible seams, and the remaining scenes were arranged according to the screenplay. Sound effects, ringtones, message notifications, and background ambience were added and carefully synchronized with on-screen action. The final video was exported after checking the full sequence, and the podcast audio was mixed separately using the same voice recordings.

CHAPTER 20 CHALLENGES FACED

One of the major challenges in producing THE WARNING was achieving a clean, believable continuous shot for the opening two minutes. Any hesitation in dialogue, mistimed phone cue, or visible camera wobble required the entire sequence to be re-recorded, making rehearsal and precise blocking essential.

Another challenge was maintaining ambiguity about Vicky's identity without confusing the audience about what was actually happening. The story needed to raise doubt clearly enough to be understood, while withholding enough information to preserve the mystery until the end.

Synchronizing the various audio cues - the unknown caller's ringtone, Vicky's ringtone, message notifications, and the second phone ringing on the last bench - at exactly the right moments was also demanding, since even a small delay could weaken the intended effect of each reveal.

CHAPTER 21 LEARNING OUTCOMES

Through this project, several practical skills were developed. The project provided direct experience in planning and executing a continuous long-take shot, which required detailed blocking, precise dialogue timing and close coordination between the actors and the camera.

The project also demonstrated how suspense can be built primarily through withheld information and sound design rather than through visible danger, and how a familiar, trustworthy character can be made unsettling through nothing more than a single text message.

The radio podcast adaptation provided additional experience in translating visual absence - such as an empty space behind a character - into audio-only tension through silence, panning and voice performance, reinforcing how differently the same story must be told across different mediums.

CHAPTER 22 EXPECTED OUTCOME

The final outcome of the project is a short psychological thriller titled THE WARNING, built around a continuous long-take opening, supported by a radio podcast adaptation of the same story. The film is expected to engage the audience by making them question a familiar, trusted character using only a warning call and a text message.

The project demonstrates the practical use of long-take cinematography, identity-based suspense and audio storytelling. The looping, open-ended conclusion allows the audience to form their own interpretation of who the unknown caller is and what the repeating timeline represents, rather than providing a direct explanation.

CHAPTER 23 CONCLUSION

The THE WARNING project demonstrates how an everyday moment between two friends can be developed into a tense psychological thriller through careful use of a continuous long take, natural dialogue and precise sound design. The story begins with an ordinary phone conversation and gradually introduces doubt through a warning call, a suspicious message, a failed phone test and a mysterious second phone.

The project combines screenplay writing, long-take cinematography, acting, sound design and editing, with each element contributing to a suspense built on uncertainty rather than visible threat. The use of two simple locations and three characters demonstrates that an effective short thriller does not require complex production resources, but careful planning and timing.

The radio podcast adaptation further demonstrates how storytelling must be reshaped when moving from a visual medium to an audio one, replacing continuous camera movement, visual absence and a silent phone with footsteps, ringtones, reverb and deliberate silence.

Overall, THE WARNING provides practical experience in both film making and radio podcasting while demonstrating the importance of trust, timing and ambiguity in building suspense.

"Some warnings arrive too late to matter — and some never stop repeating